

Chapter 110-3

Liang Shi would soon be joining the production crew to film. Recently, Zhao Ying had been so exhausted that she rarely posted on her Moments anymore.¹ One day at three in the morning, she even sent Liang Shi a WeChat message saying she still hadn't wrapped up for the day. She also sent Liang Shi a photo of the night scene at the set and asked: 【Why did I decide to enter this industry back then, and even drag you along?】

The next day, Liang Shi woke up and replied: 【Because of passion, I guess.】

Zhao Ying instantly replied: 【I just got back to the hotel. I've discovered I'm more passionate about sleeping.】

A few seconds later, another message came: 【Passion and all that can go die. I'm going home to do my dreaming!】

This sentence looked familiar. As Liang Shi read it aloud, she ended up singing it.

Only then did she realize it was a non-mainstream hit song that had been popular during their student days.²

Different worlds, same youth.

It amused Liang Shi for quite a while.

But it would soon be her turn. Because this drama's director was strict and was aiming for awards, and in order to meet the platform's broadcast schedule, they had to finish filming within a month and a half—and it was still a massive 36-episode production.

It was too difficult.

In situations like this, working through the night was completely normal. It required all staff members to tough it out together.

Liang Shi said she understood, but her body might not be able to hold up when the time came.

She used to film night scenes often and stay up late too. But after transmigrating here, Xu Qingzhu's schedule was too healthy—she basically had to be asleep before 11 PM every night. Except for that period when she first joined Minghui, but even then, Liang Shi hadn't stayed up with her and had maintained a normal schedule.

After more than two months of regular sleep, now whenever she stayed up late, she would be dead tired the next day.

Her body couldn't support her returning to that day-and-night-reversed lifestyle.

She estimated she would have to tough it out when she first joined the crew.

But the most important issue right now was still the script.

When the director let her come back before, he had said that if she had time, she should memorize all her lines. Otherwise, if they started filming and she kept getting stuck because she couldn't remember her lines, he would really lose his temper.

Liang Shi had agreed without hesitation.

She was free now, so she began memorizing her lines. The most important thing was to sort out the character relationships and scenes, then memorize based on context.

She was very serious when memorizing, and to avoid disturbing Liang Wanwan, she memorized silently.

What Liang Wanwan drew was her earnestly reading the script.

Her long brown curly hair was casually tied back with a black hair tie. She wore light-colored loungewear, with the long sleeves rolled up to reveal her forearms. On her wrist was a silver, sparkling bracelet. Her eyes were lowered as she earnestly read the pages densely covered with text, a black pen held between her slender fingers.

Her fingers were slender with distinct knuckles, yet they looked soft.

The pen casually spun between her fingers. The cold sunlight from outside refracted in, making her whole person appear gentle and beautiful.

Like a quiet ink wash painting.

Liang Wanwan picked up her pen and began to draw. The ballpoint pen naturally affected her performance, but she didn't draw any less seriously just because it was a ballpoint pen.

On the contrary, in the quiet space, she could concentrate better. Once she entered the state of drawing, it was like switching to sage mode³—she would only be immersed in her own world.

Her strokes were almost flawless.

After finishing the drawing of the earnest Liang Shi, she placed it face-down to the side and took a fresh blank sheet of paper.

Liang Wanwan wanted to draw a picture of Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu together, because it was too beautiful.

Two beautiful people standing there was already a painting in itself.

But as she thought about it, she felt every scene was equally beautiful, making it difficult to choose which one to draw.

She pondered for a long time in her mind, conflicted and hesitant.

But the moment her pen touched the paper, that scene flowed from her mind onto the page.

It was the scene from this morning when the two of them stood at the entryway. Xu Qingzhu slightly tiptoed and leaned in, wiping away a smudge from Liang Shi's collar.

Xu Qingzhu's expression was serious. Liang Shi lowered her head to look at her hair ends—just one centimeter more and she could have kissed her.

It was the perfect ambiguous distance.

In that moment, the two of them seemed to automatically form their own little world.

No one could intrude.

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1. "朋友圈" (Péngyou quān, Moments) is the social feed feature on WeChat where users can post updates, photos, and videos that their friends can see—similar to Facebook's timeline or Instagram's feed. ↵
 2. "非主流" (fēi zhǔliú, non-mainstream) refers to an alternative youth subculture popular in China during the late 2000s, characterized by emo-style fashion, dramatic hairstyles, and emotional/melodramatic music and content. "Non-mainstream hit songs" from that era often had dramatic, emotional lyrics. ↵
 3. "賢者模式" (xiánzhě móshì, sage mode) is internet slang referring to a state of extreme calm, clarity, and focus—often used humorously to describe the peaceful, zen-like mental state one enters when deeply concentrated on something. ↵